
Donald Trump's Reaction to His New, Fawning Time Cover Tells Us One Thing for Absolutely Sure

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As asinine as it is that our president decided to pick a fight with [Time magazine](#) because he doesn't like the photo of him that was chosen for its most recent cover, what really grinds my gears is that, well, I see his point. It is a pretty bad picture.

If you haven't seen it yet, I'm talking about a cover that Trump, by all accounts, should have been thrilled with: It features the cover line "His Triumph" and essentially implies he solved Middle East peace, which [could help with a certain prize he's obsessed with](#). Trump has long been both enthralled with legacy media institutions like Time and harbored a chip on his shoulder about how they cover him, so finally, here was a win. But Trump couldn't see past the choice of cover photo, because of course he couldn't. So he fired off a classic rant on Truth Social: "Time Magazine wrote a relatively good story about me, but the picture may be the Worst of All Time. They 'disappeared' my hair, and then had something floating on top of my head that looked like a floating crown, but an extremely small one. Really weird!"

He went on: "I never liked taking pictures from underneath angles, but this is a super bad picture, and deserves to be called out. What are they doing, and why?"

The living Israeli hostages held in Gaza have been freed under the first phase of Donald Trump's peace plan, alongside a Palestinian prisoner release. The deal may become a signature achievement of Trump's second term, and it could mark a strategic turning point for the Middle... pic.twitter.com/0bZDABIDGj

— TIME (@TIME)
[October 13, 2025](#)

Again, I am loathe to take Trump's side here, but is he not right that it's a "super bad picture"? Have I too not transformed into a petty tyrant when confronted with an ungainly representation of myself? My bad behavior has consisted of begging a friend to delete it, not wild-eyed ranting, but still. I would also hate it if a photo of me "disappeared" my hair or captured me from "underneath angles," famously the worst angles, and goddammit, Trump has once again gifted us some incredible syntax here. "Deserves to be called out," he wrote, as if it was bad service from an airline. "What are they doing, and why?" I love how he's suddenly capable of asking direct, prosecutorial questions when it's about something that doesn't matter at all. I'm a little confused about the "floating crown" part, though, if we're being honest. Does he just mean the M in the magazine's logo?

It should go without saying that I don't support Trump using the office of the presidency to whine about pictures of himself he doesn't like. All I'm saying is that I get it. Who among us hasn't felt this? Before long, his political opponents, including California troll-in-chief Gavin Newsom, were sort of making his point for him:

<https://t.co/pGn2xOkflb> pic.twitter.com/qKescbwmQy

Still, I was surprised, frankly, that Trump still has it in him to be this vain. It's not like he looks great most of the time. He's 79! I've seen so many other awful pictures of him! His famous coif might be styled to look some version of presentable on TV, but it's not all that surprising that it looks a little thin from below. But maybe this being on a cover that was ostensibly supposed to be praising him made it sting that much harder.

In Time's defense, the magazine is not beholden to Trump or making his administration look good—physically or otherwise—nor should it be. The way the photo might be slightly undercutting the cover line is part of what makes it interesting, and a strong visual choice. As for Trump, he has out-narcissist-ed himself once again. It's not a good look, sir, and deserves to be called out.

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